

How Future Visions are Received: Connecting Future Making to Commonplace Values

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As future visions increasingly influence public policy, innovation, and organizational strategy, questions arise not only about how these visions are imagined and created, but also on how they are received. While design and futures making literature often emphasizes values and desirability, less attention has been paid to how futures gain cultural credibility and social resonance. This paper introduces commonplace values, a rhetorical-theoretical concept grounded in McKeon's work, to address this gap. We argue that shared societal values function as interpretive anchors, making futures legible, persuasive, and desirable across publics. Drawing on recent theorizing on value-based future making, emancipatory design inquiry, and rhetorical foresight, we propose a value-based framework – Desirability, Realism, Narrative Construction and Commonplace – for evaluating and constructing future visions that align with collective ethical commitments. This contribution reframes the role of values in futures not as abstract ideals, but as culturally situated, communicative structures that determine whether futures are embraced, ignored, or contested. The framework offers both a conceptual advance and a practical reference for designers, strategists, and foresight practitioners aiming to create futures that are not only desirable, but credible and socially grounded.

Keywords: *McKeon, Future visioning, Societal values, Foresight, Future making*

Expected Contributions

- Introduces a theoretical framework for future visioning and value-based future making in design, with a focus on how futures are received, legitimized, and contested in social contexts.
- Integrates McKeon's concept of the commonplace with recent work on value-based future making, emancipatory design inquiry, and rhetorical foresight to theorize how shared societal values shape the reception of future visions.
- Demonstrates the framework through a real-world strategic design case, offering practical guidance for creating socially grounded, credible, and actionable future visions.